

CAPTAIN MAR-VELL

Protector of the Universe

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FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Mar-Vell

OCCUPATION

Captain in Kree space fleet

BASE

Mobile

HEIGHT 6 ft 2 in

WEIGHT 240 lbs

EYES Blue

HAIR White; transformed to blond by Eon, a cosmic caretaker

FIRST APPEARANCE

Marvel Super Heroes #18
(January 1968)



Kree nega-bands convert Captain Mar-Vell's psionic energy into incredible power.

Captain Mar-Vell was a member of the Kree, an alien humanoid race who built an empire known as the Greater Magellanic Cloud. Captain Mar-Vell was a "White Kree," who have the same skin color as Caucasian Earth humans and similar physiology. (Most members of the Kree race have blue skin.) As captain of a Kree space fleet, Mar-Vell distinguished himself in battles against the shape-changing Skrulls, the Kree's age-old foes.

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

• *The Life of Captain Mar-Vell*

1991 (tpb) Mar-Vell battles Thanos and performs other feats of cosmic heroism.

• *Avengers #89-#97*

The Avengers aid Mar-Vell during the epic Kree-Skrull War.

• *The Death of Captain Mar-Vell*

(tpb) Captain Mar-Vell succumbs to cancer, but achieves a hero's death.

POWERS

Thanks to his Kree "nega-bands," Mar-Vell possessed great strength (he could lift 10 tons), a high degree of imperviousness to harm, and the ability to fly. He could also exist in outer space without having to breathe.

Mar-Vell gained the ability to fire bolts of solar energy after his ailing psionic partner Rick Jones was treated with life-saving electromagnetic radiation by Professor Benjamin Savannah.

Mar-Vell impersonated a dead scientist named Dr. Walter Lawson when he first came to Earth.

PROTECTOR

Captain Mar-Vell's qualities did not go unremarked by the SUPREME INTELLIGENCE, the force that governed the Kree. Wary of mankind's growing scientific abilities, the Intelligence sent Mar-Vell to sabotage the planet's space programs. However Mar-Vell grew to respect the people of Earth and helped them, earning the soubriquet "Captain Marvel."

The Supreme Intelligence then used Mar-Vell to forge a telepathic link with a human being. The Intelligence believed that humans possessed vast psionic potential, which it longed to possess. It would then destroy humanity. The Intelligence secretly enabled Mar-Vell to bond with Rick Jones by means of a pair of Kree "nega-bands."

The Intelligence used the psionic link

with Jones to nullify the Skrull space fleet. The effort almost cost Jones his life, and Mar-Vell used his own life force to revive Jones. Mar-Vell then defeated THANOS, who wished to destroy all life in the universe. Mar-Vell also met with the alien being Eon, who gave him "cosmic awareness," persuaded him to renounce the Kree's warmongering ways, and designated him "Protector of the Universe."

During a battle with the NITRO of the Lunatic Legion, an alien-criminal organization formed by a band of renegade Kree scientists, Mar-Vell was exposed to a carcinogenic gas. Mar-Vell subsequently developed cancer and died on Saturn's moon, Titan, surrounded by his lover, Elysia, Rick Jones, the AVENGERS (who posthumously made him an honorary member), and many Super Hero friends. Mar-Vell's son, Genis-Vell, eventually took over his mantle. Later, the original Captain Mar-Vell returned, but during the Secret Invasion (see pp. 326-7) he was revealed to be a SKRULL. He turned against his superiors and sided with Earth, but was killed in the war. Recently, Noh-Varr (MARVEL BOY) became the latest Captain Marvel, serving with the AVENGERS under Norman Osborn (see GREEN GOBLIN). **MT, MF**



In delirium while dying from cancer, Captain Mar-Vell is haunted by terrifying phantoms of the enemies he fought and defeated during his career as a Super Hero.

